

- 35 Premature babies are often born with a condition where the cartilage in the gas exchange system is weaker than normal.

The baby usually recovers from this condition after a few days.

Common symptoms of this condition are wheezing and a shortness of breath.

Which statement explains why these symptoms are associated with this condition?

- A Bronchi are unable to resist external pressure on their walls, causing their cross-sectional area to reduce and limit air flow into the terminal bronchioles.
- B Terminal bronchioles do **not** have sufficient strength within their walls to maintain a full opening, reducing the volume of air that can flow into the respiratory bronchioles.
- C Alveoli are unable to recoil after breathing out, resulting in a reduced volume for the next breath, causing a lower capacity for gas exchange across the squamous epithelium.
- D Respiratory bronchioles are more likely to collapse, causing the pathway into many individual alveoli to close, and preventing the removal of waste gases from the alveoli.